

George Washington Carver

The Boy Who Helped Plants Grow

The true story of the boy neighbours called the Plant Doctor, who walked miles to find a school, then helped farmers bring tired soil back to life.

Before reading

Look at the cover. What is little George holding in his hands? What do plants need to grow?

While reading

1. Why did people call George the Plant Doctor?
2. What did George do when the school would not let him in?
3. What was the school on wheels for?

After reading

1. George noticed when plants needed help. How can you tell when a friend needs help?
2. What could you share that you know how to do?
3. What would you like to grow?

The big idea

Notice. Care. Share.

It works for plants, pets and people: notice what they need, care for them, and share what you learn.

Try this together

Be a Plant Doctor. Choose a houseplant or sow a bean. For a month, your child checks its soil, water and light each week and draws how it changes.

Words to talk about

seedling · soil · farmer · notice · care · share

Tips for reading aloud: pause on the pictures and let children notice details first. There are no wrong answers to these questions; follow your child's curiosity. The back of the book has four simple experiments to try, and a free activity pack is at tarkasatales.com/activities.

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